

The Missing Link — Studio

Turn raw video + audio into a finished podcast — on your own computer, for free.

You bring a camera and a microphone; everything else is set up for you.

Free tools a 12-year-old can use: OBS, Audacity, FFmpeg, Whisper, Canva,

Spotify for Creators, YouTube — plus the one-window Studio app.

The show: why Nepalis who love their country still migrate — villages, energy, tourism.

The journey of one episode

1. Record — camera + mic into OBS; files land in raw/.
2. Clean — one click removes hiss, rumble, clicks, harsh s's.
3. Choose — auto-split into topics; tick what to keep.
4. Master — auto -16 LUFS loudness, MP3 + MP4, PASS/FAIL.
5. Caption — Whisper writes the transcript + subtitles.
6. Publish — Spotify for Creators + YouTube. Done.

You never touch the command line — one window runs every step.

Before you start (one time only)

1. Install 3 free apps: OBS Studio, Audacity, Python.
2. Run the helper: `bash scripts/setup.sh` (checks FFmpeg, installs Whisper in a `.venv`).
3. Make 3 free accounts with an adult: Spotify for Creators, YouTube, Drive/MEGA.
4. Start the Studio: `python3 scripts/studio.py` → open `http://127.0.0.1:8765`

The Studio window, button by button

① Clean audio — high-pass, FFT denoise, de-click, de-ess, compression (light/medium/strong).

② Split into segments — Whisper transcribes; audio grouped into tagged topics & sub-sections.

Tick what to keep — untick whole segments or single sub-sections; see kept length live.

③ Rebuild (keep ticked) — FFmpeg re-joins only kept parts; audio + video stay in sync.

④ Master (-16 LUFS) — two-pass loudness; exports episode.mp3 + episode.mp4; PASS/FAIL.

Subtitles — Whisper writes episode.txt + episode.srt.

Segments vs. sub-sections — the editing superpower

You edit by MEANING, not by scrubbing a waveform.

SEGMENT 'kings · villages · roads' 04:12-09:30 [keep]

- 'return to the villages movement' 04:12-05:40 [keep]

- 'a rambling tangent about lunch' 05:40-06:55 [drop]

- 'roads, schools, clinics promised' 06:55-09:30 [keep]

SEGMENT 'geothermal · tato pani · tourism' 09:30-14:05 [keep]

Keep a topic, drop one tangent inside it, then press Rebuild. Nothing is lost.

Publish everywhere — for free

Audio → Spotify for Creators: upload episode.mp3; it auto-builds your RSS feed;

1-click to Spotify; submit the RSS to Apple Podcasts. RSS keeps you portable.

Video → YouTube: upload episode.mp4; add captions/episode.srt; reuse chapters;

add the 1400x1400 cover as the thumbnail.

Then back up the whole episode folder to the cloud — never keep only one copy.

Cheat-sheet (terminal optional — all of these are also buttons)

Start the Studio:	<code>python3 scripts/studio.py</code>
New episode:	<code>bash scripts/new_episode.sh 01 "The Missing Link"</code>
Clean audio:	<code>bash scripts/clean_audio.sh episodes/01-the-missing-link medium</code>
Split into segments:	<code>python3 scripts/segment_episode.py episodes/01-the-missing-link</code>
Rebuild from choices:	<code>python3 scripts/render_selection.py episodes/01-the-missing-link</code>
Master to -16 LUFS:	<code>bash scripts/process_episode.sh episodes/01-the-missing-link</code>
Subtitles:	<code>python3 scripts/transcribe.py episodes/01-the-missing-link</code>

Done is better than perfect

Record · Clean · Choose · Master · Caption · Publish — then do it again next week.

Full guides live in 02-implementation/ · the show's story lives in 03-content/.